BUILD YOUR OWN COLOUR WHEELS

Two paper colour wheels to cut out and assemble: one to mix colours, one to find colours that go together.

YOU NEED

- A printer and 4 sheets of A4 paper, ideally thick (160-250 g/m²), or ordinary paper glued onto thin card.
- Scissors, a craft knife and a cutting mat.
- Two paper fasteners (split pins), about 10 mm long.
- Optional: a glue stick, and lamination to make the discs last longer.

1. PRINT

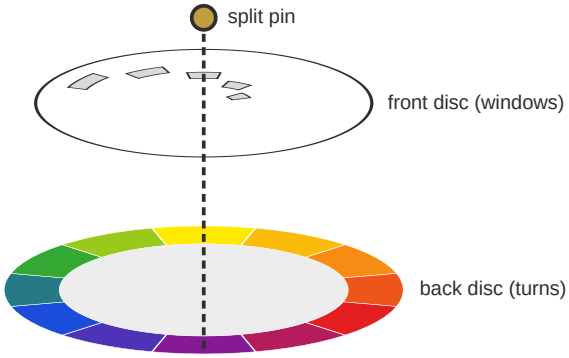
- Print pages 3 to 6 at actual size (100 %, no "fit to page").
- Each page has a 100 mm bar: measure it to check the scale.
- On thin paper, glue each page onto card before cutting.

2. CUT

- Cut each disc along its solid outer line.
- Cut out every hatched window with the craft knife, on the mat. Cut from the corners inward and keep the blade upright.
- Pierce the centre of each disc at the small cross, with the tip of the knife or a needle.

3. ASSEMBLE

- Lay the back disc (the one with all the colours) face up.
- Put the front disc (the one with the windows) face up on top of it, centres aligned.
- Push a split pin through both centres and open its legs behind. Do not press too tight: the back disc must turn freely.



THE PIECES

- Page 3 - Disc 1, back: the 12 colours and their mixtures.
- Page 4 - Disc 1, front: 5 mixing windows, grey scale and definitions.
- Page 5 - Disc 2, back: the 12 colours with tint, tone and shade.
- Page 6 - Disc 2, front: 20 windows and the harmony diagram.

HOW TO USE THEM

DISC 1 - MIXING COLOURS

- Turn the back disc. Each coloured tab on the edge of the front disc names a colour to add: red, yellow, blue, white or black.
- The colour on the outer ring, just beyond a tab, is the base colour. The tab's window shows what you get by mixing the two in equal parts.
- Example: turn orange to the "+ blue" tab; the window shows the dark, dull colour of orange and blue mixed (they are complementary).
- The grey scale on the lower half goes from value 1 (black) to value 10 (white). Hold a colour next to it to judge how light or dark it is.

DISC 2 - COLOUR RELATIONSHIPS

- Turn the back disc until the colour you want shows in the top window, marked "pure colour", where the arrow points.
- Complementary: the window opposite, at the bottom.
- Split complementary: the two windows on either side of the complement.
- Triad: the windows at the corners of the triangle with equal sides.
- Tetrad: the windows at the corners of either rectangle.
- Diad: the windows two steps away from the top one, on either side.
- Each large window also shows its colour as a tint (with white), a tone (with grey) and a shade (with black).

COLOUR WORDS

Primary colours: red, yellow and blue: they cannot be mixed from other colours.

Secondary colours: orange, green and violet: two primaries mixed.

Tertiary colours: a primary mixed with a neighbouring secondary, such as red-orange.

Warm colours: reds, oranges and yellows: they seem to come forward.

Cool colours: greens, blues and violets: they seem to move back.

Hue: another name for a colour, such as red or blue-green.

Tint: a colour plus white.

Tone: a colour plus grey.

Shade: a colour plus black.

Value: how light or dark a colour is.

Chroma: how bright or dull a colour is (also intensity or saturation).

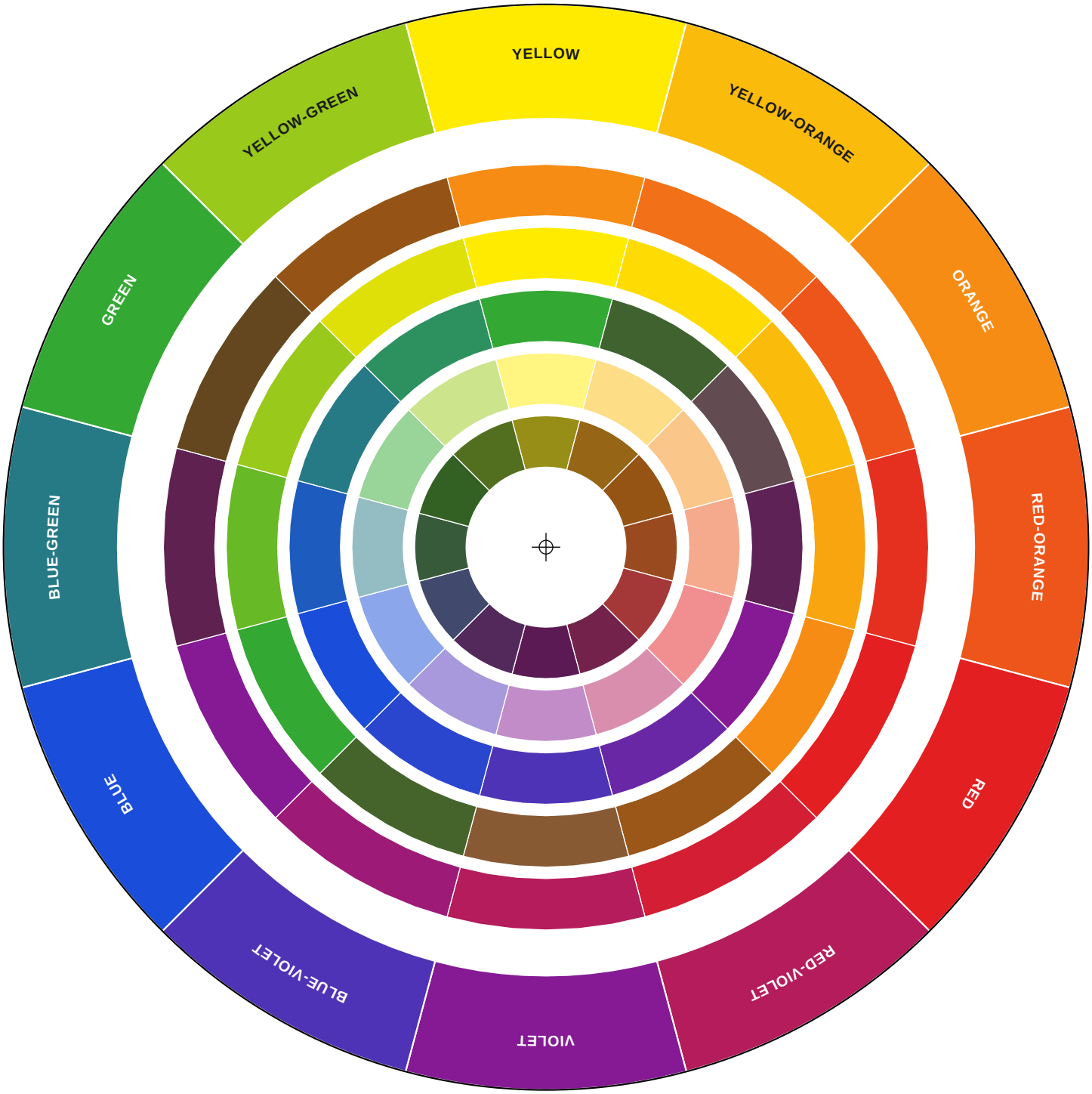
Neutral grey: black and white mixed, with no hue.

Key colour: the main colour of a colour scheme.

The printed colours are a guide: real paints mix a little differently, depending on their pigments.

DISC 1 - BACK (TURNS)

0 Print at 100 %: this bar must measure 100 mm. 100 mm



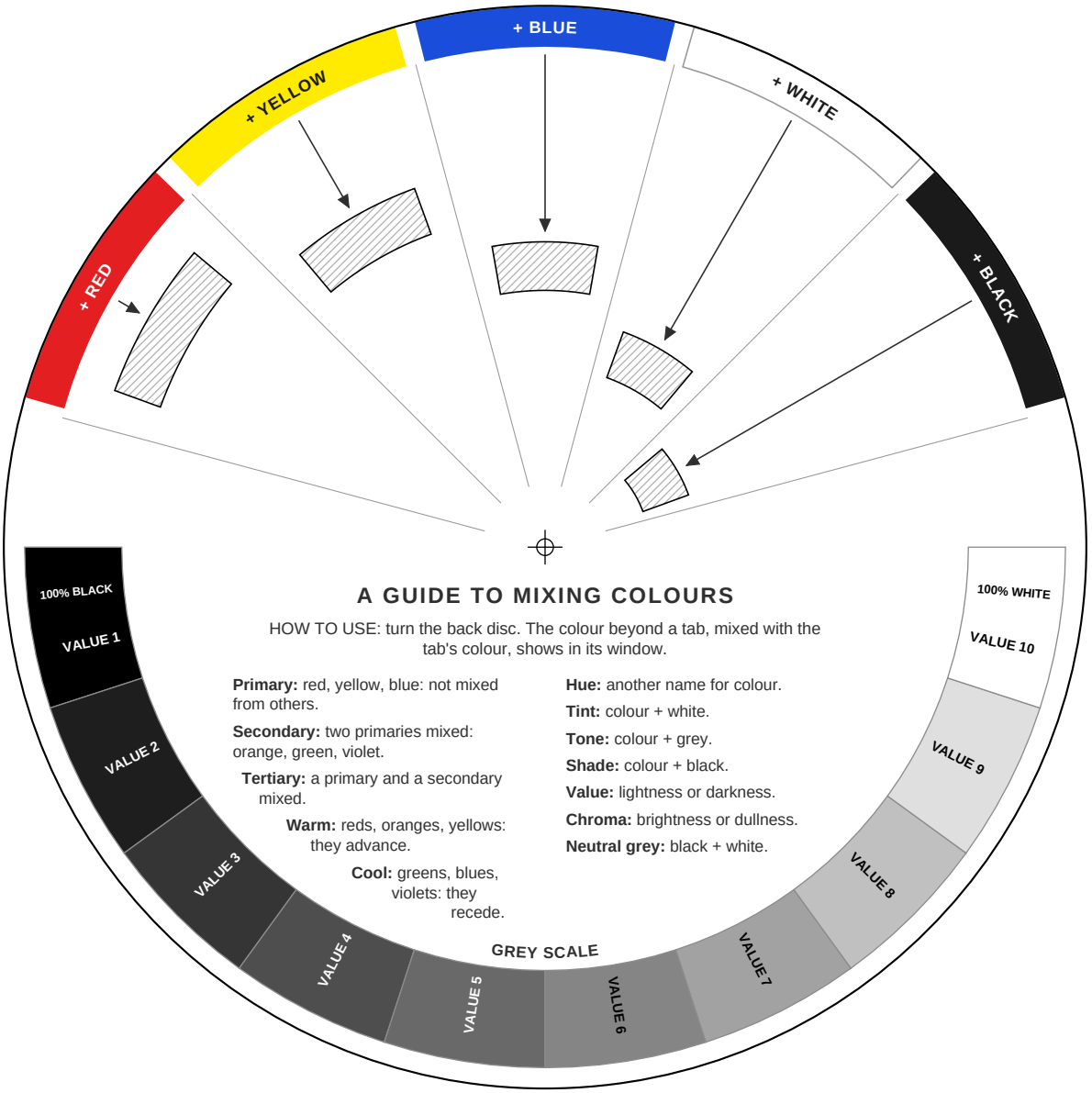
Cut along the solid lines

Hatched: cut out

Cross: pierce here

DISC 1 - FRONT (WINDOWS)

0 Print at 100 %: this bar must measure 100 mm. 100 mm



A GUIDE TO MIXING COLOURS

HOW TO USE: turn the back disc. The colour beyond a tab, mixed with the tab's colour, shows in its window.

Primary: red, yellow, blue: not mixed from others.

Secondary: two primaries mixed: orange, green, violet.

Tertiary: a primary and a secondary mixed.

Warm: reds, oranges, yellows: they advance.

Cool: greens, blues, violets: they recede.

Hue: another name for colour.

Tint: colour + white.

Tone: colour + grey.

Shade: colour + black.

Value: lightness or darkness.

Chroma: brightness or dullness.

Neutral grey: black + white.

Cut along the solid lines

Hatched: cut out

Cross: pierce here

DISC 2 - BACK (TURNS)

0 Print at 100 %: this bar must measure 100 mm. 100 mm



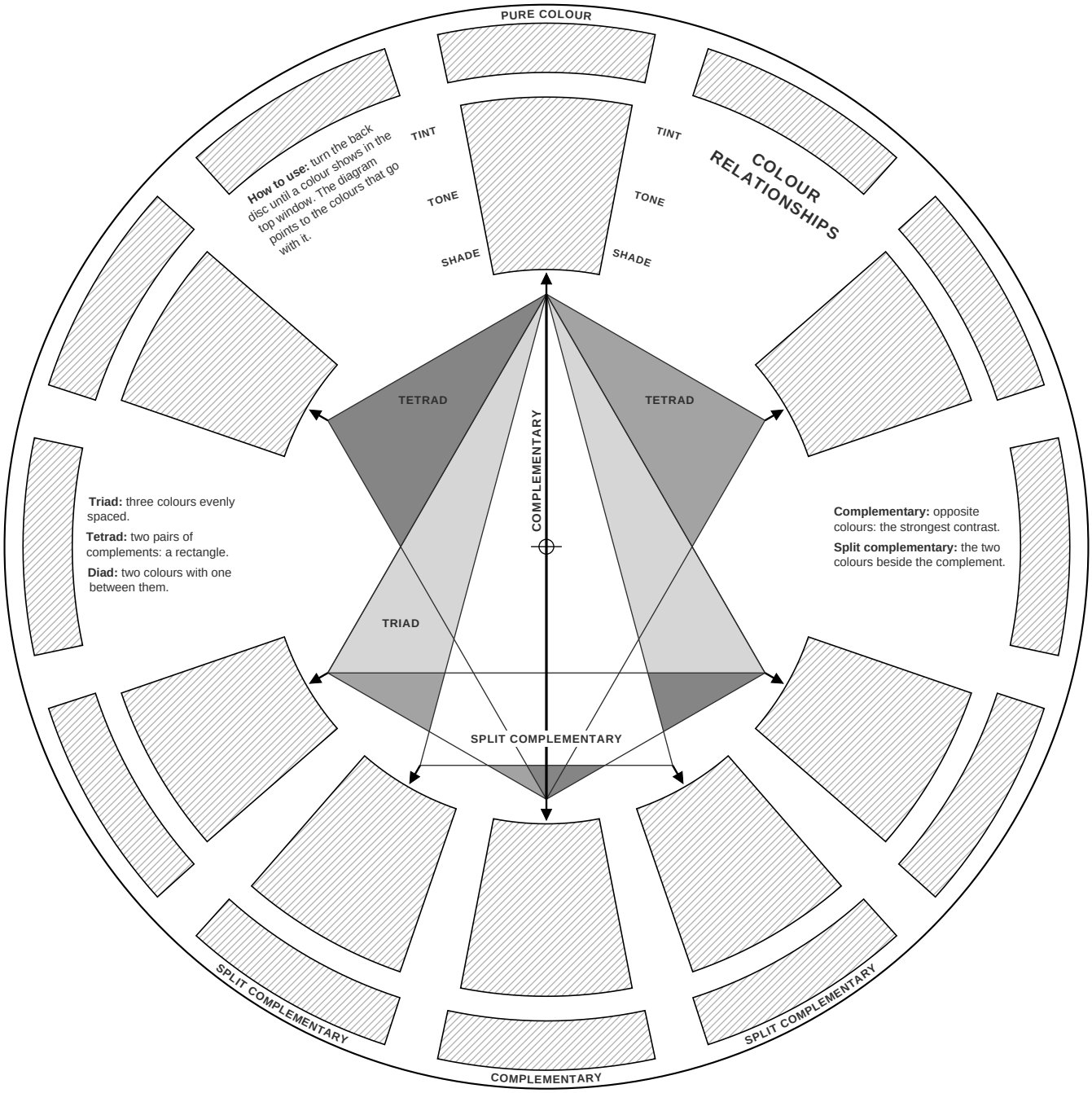
Cut along the solid lines

Hatched: cut out

Cross: pierce here

DISC 2 - FRONT (WINDOWS)

0 Print at 100 %: this bar must measure 100 mm. 100 mm



Cut along the solid lines Hatched: cut out Cross: pierce here